

Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Chief Executive Officer: Ashish Bagga

Editor: Prabhu Chawla
Managing Editors: Raj Chengappa, Dilip Bobb, Shankkar Aiyar
Editor-at-Large: S. Prasannarajan, Executive Editor: Kaverie Bamzai
Deputy Editors: Farzand Ahmed, Damayanti Datta, Ashok K. Damodaran, Sharda Ugra
Senior Editors: Saurabh Shukla, MUMBAI: Malini Bhupta, HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon
Photo Editor: Bandede Singh
Art Editor: Sapnaa Kapoor
Associate Editors: Bhavna Vij-Aurora, S. Sahaya Ranjit, Priya Sahgal, Sandeep Unnithan, AHMEDABAD: Uday Mahurkar, LUCKNOW: Subhash Mishra
Assistant Editors: Nivedita Mukherjee, THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: M.G. Radhakrishnan, KOLKATA: Elora Sen
Special Correspondents: Shafi Rahmani, CHANDIGARH: Arvind Chhabra, JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar, BANGALORE: Nirmala Ravindran
Principal Correspondents: Mihir Srivastava, Nandini Vaish; BANGALORE: Stephen David, Swagata Sen; BHOPLA: Ambresh Mishra, MUMBAI: Jhilmil Motihar, PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava
Copy Desk: Nardeep Singh Dahiya (Senior Editor), Anamika Chatterjee, Kaushik Deka, Rahul Kumar, Anika Kumar, Sangram Keshari Parhi, Shilpi, Priyanka Sood, Shweta Srivastava, Rahul Tewari, Priya Verma, Anju Yadav
Photo Department: Hemant Chawla, Sipra Das, Yasbant Negi, Ravi Sahani, Vikram Sharma, Reuben Singh, AHMEDABAD: Shailesh Raval, CHENNAI: H.K. Rajashekar, MUMBAI: Mandar Deodhar, Shriya Patil, Bhaskar Paul, Rashmi Hajela (Chief Photo Researcher)
Infographics and Illustrations: Saurabh Singh, Prashant Chaudhary
Art Department: Madhu Bhaskar (Art Director), Ranjita Bhattacharji, Vandana Nayar, Jyoti K. Singh (Deputy Art Directors), Rasshi Ajmani Girdhar, Vipin Gupta, Pushvinder Kaur, Madhumangal Singh
Production Department: Surinder Hastu (Chief of Production), Harish Aggarwal, Naveen Gupta

Publishing Director: Malcolm D. Mistry
Associate Publisher: Manoj Sharma (Impact)

IMPACT TEAM

Senior General Manager: Upendra Wellingkar (West and South)
General Managers: Kaustav Chatterjee (East), V. Somasundaram (Chennai), Preeti Kohli (North), Jitendra Lad (West)
Deputy General Manager: Viswanath C.V. (Bangalore)

Consumer Marketing Services: Poonam Sangha,
Senior General Manager

Sales and Operations: Vivek Gaur, Executive Director
D.V.S. Rama Rao, Senior General Manager
Vinod Das, General Manager (Sales)
Deepak Bhatt, General Manager, Sales (North)
Rajesh Menon, General Manager, Sales (West)
M. Krishna Kiran, Deputy General Manager, Sales (South)
S. Sridhar, General Manager (Operations)



Volume XXXIV Number 41; For the week
October 6-12, 2009, released on October 5

● Editorial Office Living Media India Ltd. F-14/15, Connaught Place New Delhi 110001. Phones: 23315801-4; Fax: 23316180; Cable: Livmedia, New Delhi
● Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (UP)-201301. Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/NTNL lines); (95120) 2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078080; e-mail: weareindiatoday.com; Mumbai: 022-24444423-6; Fax: 24444358 ● Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, 201 Competent House, F-14, Middle Circle, Connaught Place, New Delhi ● Regd. Office: K-9 Connaught Circus, New Delhi 110001 ● Impact Offices: Trade Centre, 2nd Floor, Kamala City, Senapati Bagat Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai 400013; Phone: 24983355; Fax: 24982266 ● Hamilton House, 1-A, Connaught Place, New Delhi 110001; Phone: 23352233; Fax: 23327330 ● 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai, 2nd Floor, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004; Phones: 28478526-41; Telex: 041-6177 Into In; Fax: 28472178; Cable: Livmedia Chennai ● 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones: 22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; Cable: Livmedia, Bangalore ● 52, Jawaharlal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; Cable: Livmedia, Kolkata ● 6-3-885778, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498; Fax: 23403484 ● 79/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058; Fax: 2377059 ● 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchwati, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Phone: 26560393, 26560929, Fax: 26565293 ● Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited. Printed and published by Ashish Bagga on behalf of Living Media India Ltd. Printed at Thomson Press India Ltd., 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana); A-9, Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, district Kancheepuram-603209, (Tamil Nadu); and at Plot No. 5-5A, TTC Industrial Area, Thane, Belapur Road, Airoli, Navi Mumbai-400708, (Maharashtra). Published at K-9, Connaught Circus, New Delhi-110001.
● INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

For reprint rights and syndication enquiries, contact
syndications@indiatoday.com or call +91-120-4078000
www.syndicationtoday.in

From the editor-in-chief

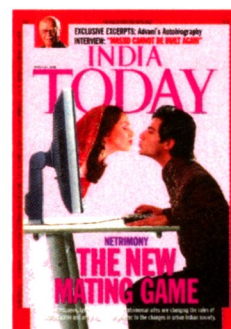
I find an uncanny resemblance between urban Indian marriages and Bollywood blockbusters. Both involve a multi-star cast, extravagant budgets, outlandish sets, religion, parental priorities and contemporary reality, song and dance, tantrums and twists and, of course, the stars: the couple getting married. While the scale of the Great Indian Wedding continues to defy economic realities, there has been a quiet revolution taking place that offers encouraging signs of a new sensibility when it comes to urban Indian men deciding on the ideal life partner. For some years now, we have obsessed over the modern Indian woman but rarely do we talk about how the average Indian man looks at her and who he considers a "suitable girl".

All that and more have come out in a partner preference survey conducted by Shaadi.com, one of India's top matrimonial sites, on 11,577 individuals across 300 cities and towns backed up by findings of two other prominent matrimonial sites. The statistics are revealing and show that most men seem to have resolved some of their life issues and their preferences are now radically different from the traditional ones we have seen in countless newspaper advertisements. Beautiful, virgin, young, with the right caste and family, along with "homely" and "fair," was the classic prototype matched by stars and planets. That vision of the ideal *bahu* was imagined by parents, the primary movers and shakers behind arranged marriages in India. Now, as the Shaadi survey reveals, parents seem happy to leave the quest to their children, especially sons. The latest figures show that 82 per cent of urban men are posting profiles and searching for "my kind of girl" themselves. A majority of parents are also asking sons to get acquainted with a partner well before the wedding date is set.

We also found similar trends in studies done by the Centre for Social Research and among the men we interviewed separately. Technology now plays matchmaker. In a cover story in 2008 we found that over 12 million Indians were using matrimonial websites and this number has increased substantially since. What the surveys show is that men are asserting personal choice and trying to find partners who not only share their goals and ambitions but help achieve them. The new trend of men looking for partners themselves is a pointer to what men are actually looking for. Beauty is not the most coveted criterion among a significant number, nor is fairness of skin, age, caste or background. Instead, the majority are using practical parameters to rate the ideal girl; compatibility, working women, maturity are attributes that seem to matter most, as are being responsible and understanding. In other words, men are seeking a soulmate.

The modern Indian male has clearly shed a lot of those old limiting signposts in choosing a lifemate. The new demands for compatibility tell the new story of masculinity: that to find a mate men are ready to work harder than ever before in seeking an equal partner rather than a docile housewife. In today's highly competitive, stress-filled world, it's a change that was perhaps inevitable but it is one for the good.

(Aroon Purie)



OUR MARCH
2008 COVER